



Step 5a: Use both hands if necessary to get a good grip on the heatsink while detaching it

over the processor's core. This step should be done very carefully, especially for AMD processors, as their main core is exposed and is not shielded like those from Intel.

STEP 8 All the newer processors come packaged with their own certified heatsinks bundled, and these are usually sufficient. However, if you are an overclocking geek or a

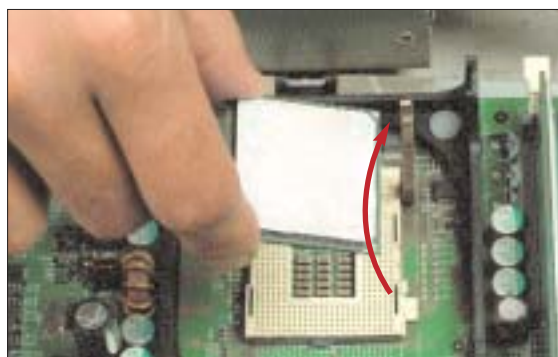


Step 7: Apply the thermal paste gently to form a thin film on the processor's surface

you need to, you're probably doing something wrong. Push down on the latch to lock the new processor in place securely.

STEP 7 After plugging the processor in, apply a little thermal grease on the top surface (See picture Step 7). You may not need to do this, as most heatsinks today come packed with paste already applied on them.

The thermal paste will absorb the heat from the processor's core and spread it evenly for the heatsink to dissipate. Apply the grease gently, and spread it evenly



Step 5c: Remember to unlock the clip (shown with a red arrow) holding the CPU down, before removing it

STEP 10 As against changing the CPU, upgrading the memory is comparatively a piece of cake, and doesn't take more than a couple of minutes.

The RAM slots are typically located close to the processor, next to the connections for the IDE cables. Unclip the latches—usually coloured white or beige—located on the ends of the slots, and pull the old memory modules free from the motherboard (See picture Step 10a).

Of course, you may need to do so only if you don't have any free slots for the RAM you want to add. Now, take the new memory module and hold it at an approximate angle of 45 degrees, at one end of the slot (See picture Step 10b). At this point, just ensure that the slit on the RAM module is lined up correctly with the corresponding spot on the motherboard's slot.

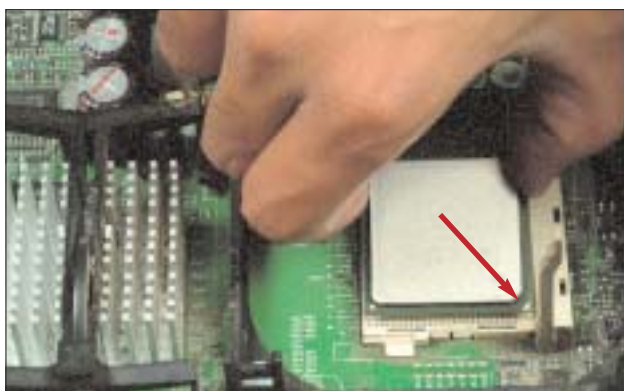
This slit is easy to identify, as its location splits the RAM module into long and short sides. Just press the module down until it slides in and fits snugly into its slot. Now, snap the clips back up manually to lock it in place.



Step 5b: Lift the heatsink clear outside the cabinet, before going for the processor

heavy-duty gamer, you may require a larger heatsink and a more powerful fan.

STEP 9 Lower the heatsink carefully. Be very gentle, or you might damage the processor core. Now, lock the heatsink into place by swinging the holding clips (See picture Step 9), this time in the clockwise direction. Finally, reconnect the fan's power cable back to its original location. If you can't find it, refer to the board layout diagram in your motherboard manual.



Step 6: Place the processor carefully, so as to not damage its core. Also line up the marking as indicated by the arrow

STEP 11 Now to mop up, just place any other components you removed back into their slots, before closing the cabinet. Reconnect all peripherals and the power cable after setting it upright.

After all that hard work, the efforts of your blood, sweat and tears—you get to press the Power Button to a

Checklist

For this all-important transplant onto your PC, you'll need only a few tools, namely:

- ✓ A Philips head (+) screwdriver for those pesky little screws
- ✓ A small box of thermal paste
- ✓ The most vital one—your motherboard manual. The manual will assist you by serving as a guide to the layout of the motherboard.

If you don't have the manual, there's no need to panic. There are dozens of free utilities on the Internet such as Motherboard Monitor and SiSoft Sandra, which can help you identify your motherboard. After identifying the component, you can simply visit the manufacturer's Web site, download the manual and print it out.